

CatDog

CatDog is an American animated sitcom created by Peter Hannan for Nickelodeon.^[1] It follows the zany hijinks of a cat and dog who are inexplicably conjoined at the waist. Nickelodeon produced the series from Burbank, California.^[2] The first episode aired on April 4, 1998, following the 1998 Kids' Choice Awards, before the series officially premiered on October 5, 1998. Similarly, the Season 2 episode "Fetch" was shown in theaters in 1998 before airing on television.^[3]

The series ended on June 15, 2005, after a total of four seasons and 68 aired episodes over seven years, plus two produced episodes that never aired. It was produced by Nickelodeon Animation Studio and Peter Hannan Productions and was released on DVD in Region 1 by Shout! Factory.

Two animation studios, Saerom Animation and Rough Draft Studios through Rough Draft Korea, worked on the animation for the series.

Premise

CatDog is set in a world of mostly anthropomorphic animals and follows the adventures of a cat and a dog who share a body despite having opposite personalities. Cat is strait-laced and intellectual whereas Dog is impulsive and happy-go-lucky. While the brothers can independently control their upper bodies with two heads, they are conjoined at the midsection, meaning they have no tail or hind legs. Cat and Dog's personality differences share similarities with *The Odd Couple*, the *Looney Tunes* shorts and elements of Laurel and Hardy, Abbott and Costello and fellow Nicktoon characters Ren and Stimpy.^[4] Because Cat and Dog cannot be separated, Dog will often drag his brother into activities Dog enjoys, such as chasing garbage trucks, eating fast food and exploring, even though Cat is reluctant to do so.

CatDog



Genre	<u>Animated sitcom</u> <u>Comedy</u> <u>Slapstick</u> <u>Surreal humour</u>
Created by	<u>Peter Hannan</u>
Creative director	<u>Robert Porter</u>
Voices of	<u>Jim Cummings</u> <u>Tom Kenny</u> <u>Carlos Alazraqui</u> <u>Maria Bamford</u> <u>Billy West</u> <u>Nika Futterman</u> <u>John Kassir</u> <u>Dwight Schultz</u> <u>Laraine Newman</u>
Theme music composer	<u>Peter Hannan</u>
Opening theme	<i>"CatDog Theme Song"</i>
Ending theme	<i>"CatDog Ending Theme Song"</i>
Composer	<u>Denis M. Hannigan</u>
Country of origin	<u>United States</u>
Original language	<u>English</u>
No. of seasons	4
No. of episodes	68 ^[a] (<u>list of episodes</u>)

Episodes

Season	Segments	Episodes	Originally
			First released
 1	41	20	April 4, 1998
 2	43	20	February 15, 1999
 3	38	20	October 9, 1999
 4	13	8	November 25, 2000

Characters

- CatDog (Cat voiced by [Jim Cummings](#) and Dog voiced by [Tom Kenny](#)), a cat and a dog conjoined hybrid twin brothers with a very long and stretchy upper body, having no tail or hind legs.
- Winslow Oddfellow (voiced by [Carlos Alazraqui](#)), a tailless blue mouse who lives next door.
- Cliff Feltbottom (voiced by [Tom Kenny](#)), a male bulldog and the leader of the Greaser Dogs.
- Shriek Dubois (voiced by [Maria Bamford](#)), a female poodle.
- Lube (voiced by [Carlos Alazraqui](#)), a male hound who falls in love.
- Rancid Rabbit (voiced by [Billy West](#)), a green rabbit.
- Eddie the Squirrel (voiced by [Dwight Schultz](#)), a gray squirrel.
- Randolph Grant (voiced by [Billy West](#))
- Tallulah Headbank (voiced by [Maria Bamford](#))
- Mean Bob (voiced by [Billy West](#))
- Lola Caricola (voiced by [Nika Futterman](#))
- The Ingrid Twins (both voiced by [Laraine Newman](#))
- Mervis and Dunglap (voiced by [John Kassir](#)), a pig and a weasel, respectively.
- Mr. Sunshine (voiced by [Billy West](#))

Production

The series, created by [Peter Hannan](#), was developed as the next Nicktoons production and produced from [Nickelodeon Animation Studio](#) in [Burbank, California](#). Hannan served as executive producer. This was part of Nickelodeon's \$350 million investment in original animation over the next five years after the series' inception.^[2]

[Albie Hecht](#), [Nickelodeon's](#) senior vice president of worldwide productions, said that the creators planned for the series to "really play off of kids' sympathies" by portraying the characters as experiencing "the worst of both worlds".^[2] Hannan said CatDog was inspired by watching neighborhood cats and dogs occasionally fight each other, and thought that it would be great to make conjoined twins Cat and Dog to

Production

Executive producer [Peter Hannan](#)

Producers [Mario Piluso](#)
[Ken Kessel](#)

Running time 23 minutes

Production companies [Peter Hannan Productions](#)

[Nickelodeon Animation Studio](#)

Original release

Network [Nickelodeon](#)

Release April 4, 1998 –
June 15, 2005

see how both of the animals would fare against other things.^[2] The idea of them being conjoined twins came from Hannan watching several news stories on TV about conjoined twins living a normal life conjoined together.^[2] Both aspects, he claimed, initially developed the idea of CatDog.^[2]

The title characters were originally envisioned as a two-headed superhero called "CatDog Man".

Broadcast

The series originally aired on Nickelodeon in the United States from 1998 to 2005, and aired reruns from 2005 to 2007. It was subsequently aired on Nicktoons from May 1, 2002, to August 23, 2011. *CatDog* began airing on NickRewind on March 23, 2013 and continued to air until November 15, 2021. The series became available for streaming on Paramount+ on July 30, 2020. In the UK and Ireland, the series was broadcast on Nickelodeon (1998–2005), Channel 4 (1999–2007), and Nicktoons (2002–13). In Canada, the series was broadcast on Nickelodeon (2009–2019) and on YTV (1998–2006). In Australia and New Zealand, the series was broadcast on Nickelodeon (1998–2015). In Japan, the series was broadcast on Nickelodeon (1999–2009) and on TV Asahi (1999–2006). In the Middle East, the series was broadcast on Nickelodeon Arabia (2008–2011) and on MBC 3 (2014–2015).

Reception

Critical

The series was reviewed by Common Sense Media with a score of 2/5 stars, advised for children 7 and up.^[5]

Awards and nominations

In 1998, the series was nominated for an Annie Award for Outstanding Individual Achievement for Writing in an Animated Television Production, for "Dog Gone". The recipients would have been Derek Drymon, Robert Porter and Peter Hannan.^[6]

At the 1999 Kids' Choice Awards, the show was nominated for Favorite Cartoon. However, it lost to *Rugrats*. It did so again in the 2000 Kids' Choice Awards.

Merchandise

Home media and digital download releases

Two VHS tapes of the series were released by Paramount Home Video on March 30, 1999. *Together Forever* contains a bonus short "Cat-Diggety Dog" plus the episodes "Dog Gone", "Flea or Die", "Diamond Fever", "CatDog's End" and "Work Force", and *CatDog vs. The Greasers* contains the episodes "Siege on Fort CatDog", "Squirrel Dog", "Full Moon Fever", "Shriek Loves Dog" and "All You Need Is Lube".

VHS releases

Title	No. of episodes	Release date	Episodes include	
Together Forever	6	March 30, 1999	2x04c	"Cat-Diggety Dog"
			1x01a	"Dog Gone"
			1x02a	"Flea or Die"
			1x05a	"Diamond Fever"
			1x12a	"CatDog's End"
			1x04b	"Work Force"
CatDog vs. The Greasers	5		1x12b	"Siege on Fort CatDog"
			1x09a	"Squirrel Dog"
			1x11a	"Full Moon Fever"
			1x04a	"Shriek Loves Dog"
			1x03b	"All You Need Is Lube"

In 2010, Nickelodeon contracted Amazon.com's CreateSpace service arm to produce DVD sets of *CatDog* and other Nickelodeon shows exclusively for sale on Amazon. The DVDs were "manufactured-on-demand" DVD-Rs to match orders. The series is also available for download on Amazon's InstantVideo service. From 2011 to 2013, Shout! Factory released the series on DVD via several season sets, and a proper complete series set was released on December 9, 2014.^{[7][8]}

CreateSpace Releases

Title	Release date	Discs	Episodes
<i>Season 1</i>	April 7, 2010	4	20
<i>Season 2, Volume 1</i>	December 1, 2010	3	17
<i>Season 2, Volume 2</i>	December 1, 2010	4	17
<i>Season 3</i>	December 1, 2010	3	13

Region 1

Title		Season(s)	Episodes	Release date	Episodes
	<i>Volume 1: Season 1, Part 1</i>	1	10	October 18, 2011	1 ("Dog Gone" / "Fan Mail" / "All You Can't Eat") – 6 ("Party Animal" / "Mush, Dog, Mush!"), 8 ("Pumped" / "Dummy Dummy"), 9 ("Squirrel Dog" / "Brother's Day"), 11 ("Full Moon Fever" / "War of the CatDog") and 14 ("Nightmare" / "CatDogPig")
	<i>Volume 2: Season 1, Part 2</i>			March 27, 2012	7 ("Armed and Dangerous" / "Fistful of Mail!"), 10 ("Escape From the Deep End" / "The Collector"), 12 ("CatDog's End" / "Siege on Fort CatDog"), 13 ("Safety Dog" / "Dog Come Home!"), 15 ("New Neighbors" / "Dead Weight") – 20 ("All About Cat" / "Trespassing")
	<i>Volume 3: Season 2, Part 1</i>	2	20	June 5, 2012 ^[9]	21 ("Send in the CatDog" / "Fishing for Trouble" / "Fetch") – 30 ("Climb Every CatDog" / "Canine Mutiny")
	<i>Volume 4: Season 2, Part 2</i>			September 25, 2012 ^[10]	31 ("It's a Wonderful Half Life" / "Shepherd Dog") – 40 ("Cliff's Little Secret" / "Freak Show")
	<i>Volume 5: The Complete Third Season^[b]</i>	3	20	March 12, 2013 ^[11]	41 ("Sumo Enchanted Evening" / "Hotel CatDog") – 60 ("New Cat in Town" / "CatDog's Booty")
	<i>Volume 6: The Complete Final Season</i>	4	8	August 20, 2013 ^[12]	61–63 ("CatDog and the Great Parent Mystery") – 68 ("Vexed of Kin" / "Meat Dog's Friends")
	<i>The Complete Series</i>	1-4	68	December 9, 2014 ^[8]	1 ("Dog Gone" / "Fan Mail" / "All You Can't Eat") – 68 ("Vexed of Kin" / "Meat Dog's Friends")

The complete series is also available for download in the [iTunes Store](#) and streaming on [Paramount+](#).

In Australia, seasons 1-3 were released on DVD by [Beyond Home Entertainment](#).

Promotions

Nickelodeon initiated a \$20 million promotional campaign for the series' first season in 1999 with partners [Burger King](#), [Duracell](#), [Jell-O](#), and [Nabisco](#).^[13] Burger King, which had promoted Nickelodeon's *The Rugrats Movie* with toys the previous year, offered *CatDog*-themed toys in its kids meals for five weeks beginning February 22, 1999.^[13] Nickelodeon promoted a trip to [Universal Studios Florida](#) as a prize in an on-air sweepstakes sponsored by Burger King and [Mattel](#), which also released a line of *CatDog* toys that year.^[13] Duracell held a back-to-school-themed backpack offer as well as a "Catch CatDog" sweepstakes on television and radio during the holiday season.^[13] Jell-O packaged *CatDog* stickers in its Jell-O Yogurt kids packs.^[13] Nabisco marketed limited edition *CatDog* Cheese Nips flavors, which featured instant-win contest prizes that included a trip to Los Angeles to meet and have their likeness drawn by creator of *CatDog*.^[13]

Video games

On May 13, 1999, Nickelodeon and Hasbro Interactive announced a three-year partnership to publish video games based on Nickelodeon television series, the first being *CatDog: Quest for the Golden Hydrant* for Microsoft Windows, which released in late 1999.^[14] Ports of the game for PlayStation and Game Boy Color were mentioned but ultimately never released.^[14] Another Hasbro title, *CatDog: Saving Mean Bob*, was announced for a 2000 release for PC and PlayStation^[15] but never released.

Characters from the series appeared as cameos or playable characters in the Nickelodeon games *Nicktoons Racing*, *Super Brawl Universe*, *Nickelodeon Kart Racers 2: Grand Prix*, *Nickelodeon All-Star Brawl*, *Nickelodeon Extreme Tennis*, and *Nickelodeon Kart Racers 3: Slime Speedway*. Characters make cameo appearances in *Nickelodeon Party Blast*, *Nicktoons: Attack of the Toybots*, and *Nicktoons MLB*.

Notes

- a. Includes 134 segments. Two episodes were unaired on television.
- b. Shout! Factory select title sold exclusively through Shout's online store.

References

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External links

- *CatDog* (<https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0154061/>) at IMDb
 - Welcome to CatDog's 1st Fan Site (<http://catdog1st.tripod.com>) – includes various interview from members of cast and crew
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